Exposed Source Code Testing

Educational Bug Bounty Series • Authorized Security Research Only

■ Exposed Source Code — Security Testing

Contributed by Cyber_Spy.404 | Educational Bug Bounty Series

Scope and ethics: *Test only authorized systems. Do not dump or publish third-party repositories, secrets, or personal data.*

■ Executive Summary

Private source code and version-control metadata can become publicly accessible through a misconfigured web server. The supplied PDF covers Git, Subversion (SVN), Mercurial (Hg), and Bazaar (Bzr) metadata directories.

■ Core Testing Methodology

1. Confirm the host and paths are in scope.
2. Check, using minimal requests, whether version-control metadata is publicly served.
3. Determine whether directory listing or metadata access is enabled.
4. Do not clone or dump a third-party repository; collect only minimal, redacted evidence.
5. Explain potential exposure of source, internal paths, history, or accidentally committed secrets.
6. Report responsibly and retest after remediation.

■ High-Value Bug Bounty Tips & Edge Cases

• The source lists `/.git`, `/.svn`, `/.hg`, and `/.bzr` as metadata exposure examples.

• A directory listing can disclose repository structure.

• Secrets removed from current code may remain in version history; rotate any confirmed exposed credentials.

• The source links to repository extraction tools, but this guide does not reproduce dumping instructions.

• These examples do not establish that a particular target is vulnerable.

■■ Educational Checklists & Safe Examples

```
Target: [Your-Domain]
Metadata category: [Git / SVN / Hg / Bzr]
Publicly accessible: [Yes / No / Inconclusive]
Directory listing enabled: [Yes / No]
Evidence: [Minimal redacted status/response]
```

• [ ] Development metadata is excluded from deployments.

• [ ] Directory indexing is disabled where unnecessary.

• [ ] Secrets are scanned and kept outside source control.

• [ ] Confirmed exposed credentials are rotated.

■■ Mitigation & Remediation

Exclude repository metadata from public web roots, deny access to version-control paths, deploy clean build artifacts, disable unnecessary directory listing, scan repositories for secrets, and rotate any exposed credentials.

■ Source Notes

Based on the supplied three-page *Exposed Source Code.pdf*. Pages 1–2 discuss Git, SVN, Mercurial, and Bazaar metadata directories and tool references. The last page has no additional readable text in the supplied preview.

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